



Redrawing the World

The 2026 UN Resolution to Abandon the Mercator Projection

The United Nations Adopts a New Cartographic Standard

In September 2026, the UN General Assembly passed a landmark resolution to replace the traditional Mercator projection with the Equal Earth map, aiming for a more accurate representation of continental landmasses.



The Outgoing Standard:
Mercator Projection
(Est. 1569)

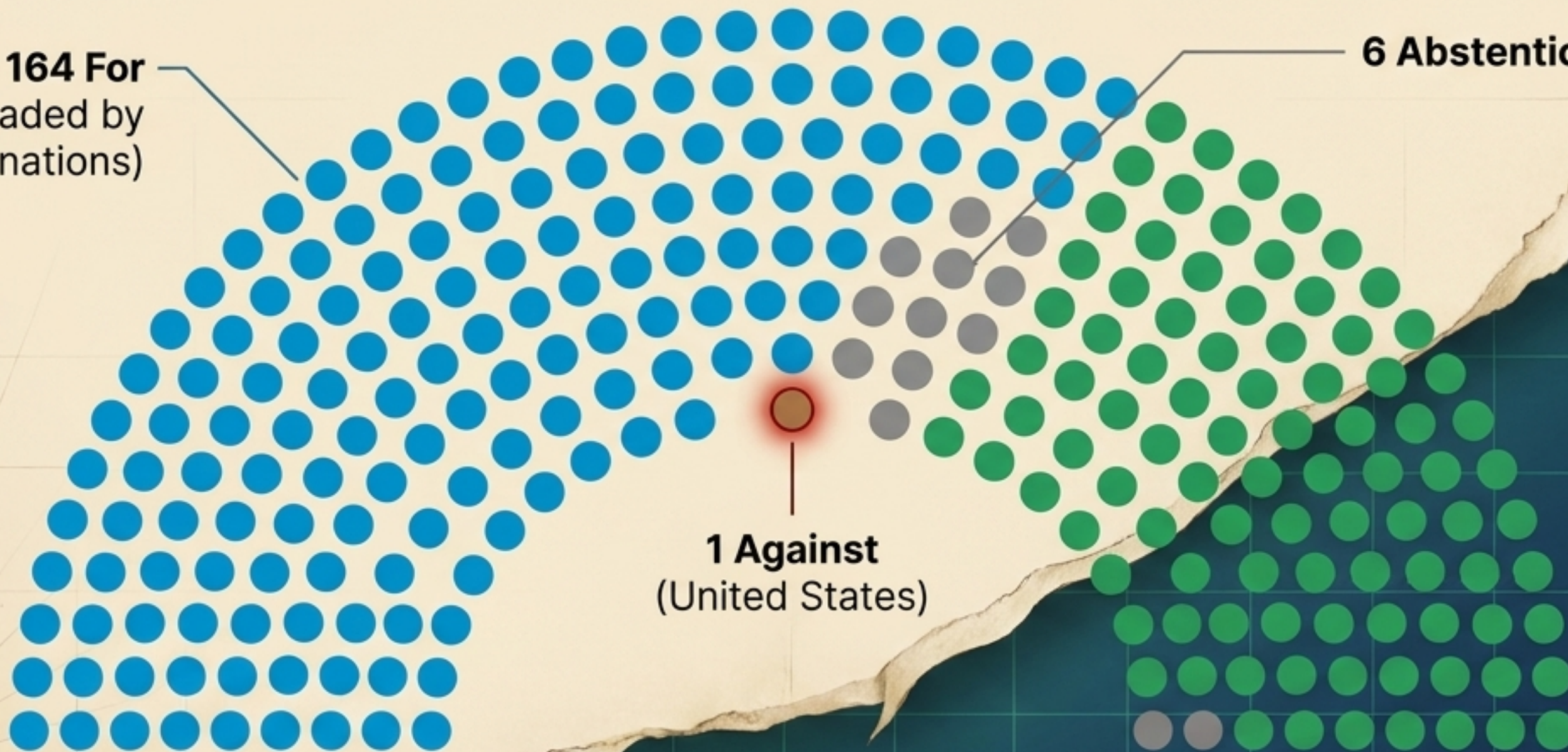
The Incoming Standard:
Equal Earth Projection
(Est. 2018)

A Global Consensus with a Singular Dissent

164 For
(Spearheaded by
African nations)

6 Abstentions

1 Against
(United States)



The 1569 Standard Built for Maritime Navigation



Designed by Flemish cartographer Gerardus Mercator, the projection prioritized accurate depictions of shapes and angles. This mathematical design allowed sailors to plot straight-line courses (rhumb lines) across oceans, a revolutionary tool for 16th-century global trade.

The 3D to 2D Distortion Effect



To keep maritime navigation angles straight, the projection **artificially inflates northern regions** and compresses equatorial zones, severely distorting relative landmass sizes.

The Illusion of Scale



Under the Mercator projection, Greenland and Africa appear to be roughly the same size. In reality, Africa is 14 times larger.

The 2018 Correction via Equal Earth



"Equal Earth preserves the relative surface areas of continents and, as much as possible, shows their shapes as they appear on a globe."
— Bojan Savric, Cartographer (2025).

Launched by a group of cartographers in 2018, this projection restores visual equity to the Southern Hemisphere.

Projection Diagnostic Matrix

Mercator		Equal Earth	
Era & Origin	1569 (Gerardus Mercator)	Era & Origin	2018 (Bojan Savric & team)
Primary Purpose	Maritime Navigation (plotting straight courses)	Primary Purpose	Accurate Representation (true comparative scale)
Geometric Focus	Preserves Shapes & Angles	Geometric Focus	Preserves Relative Surface Area
Spatial Distortion	Inflates Poles, Compresses Equator	Spatial Distortion	Proportional Continental Landmasses

The Shifting Silhouettes



SHRINKING
(Poleward Inflation
Reduced)



SHRINKING
(Reduced Distortion)



**DRAMATIC
SHRINKING**
(Extreme Polar Inflation
Corrected)



**PROPORTIONAL
EXPANSION**
(True Area Revealed)



EXPANSION
(Visual Equity Restored)



The Diplomatic Friction of Cartography



Cognitive Justice & Truth

“[Maps] guide education, nourish the imagination... they are therefore never neutral.”

— Robert Dussey, Foreign Minister of Togo.

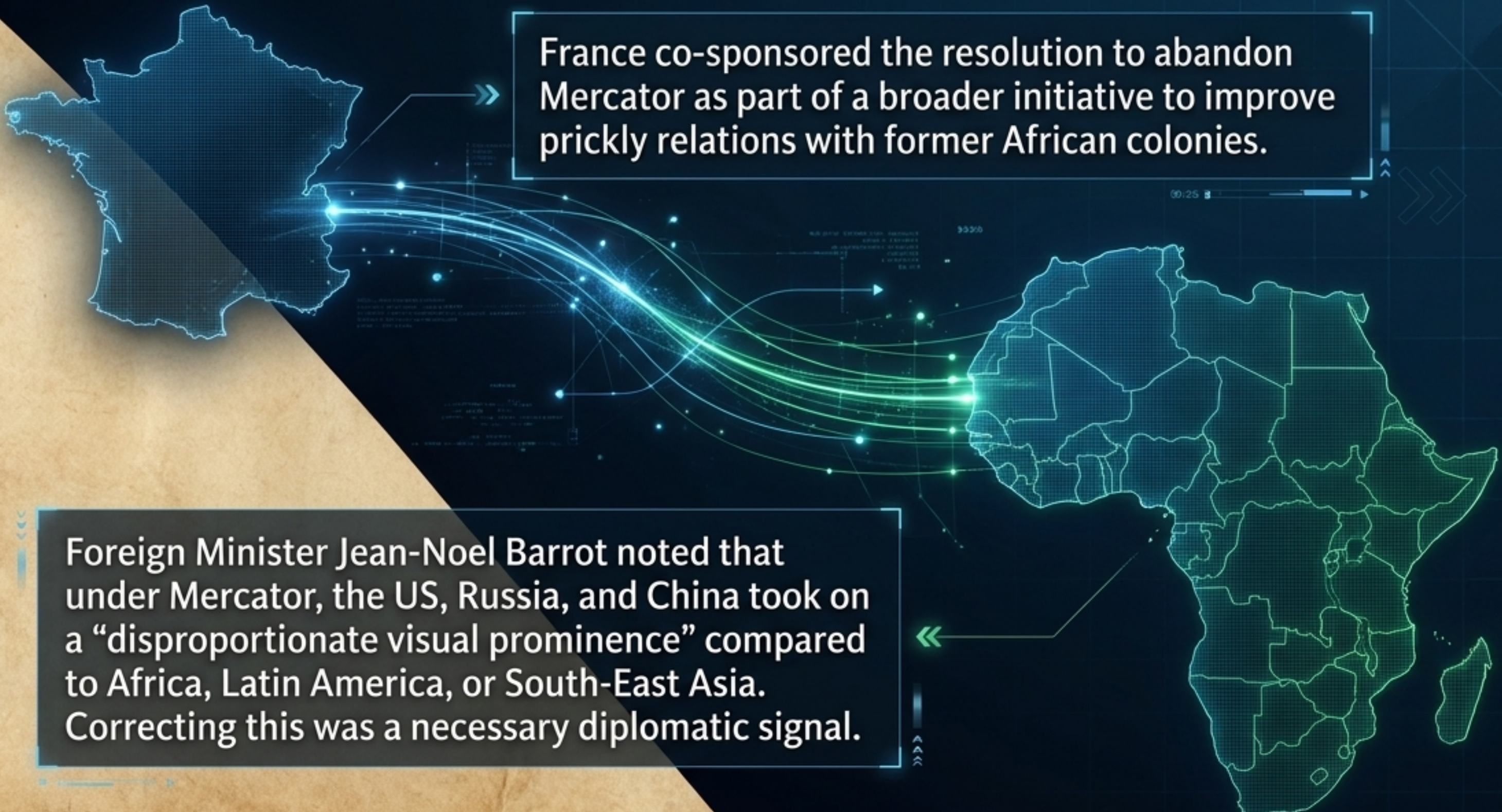


Institutional Credibility & Genuine Problems

“...debating map projects from the 16th century and their role in promoting reparations and cognitive justice.”

— Yaryna Ferencevych, US Representative.

Recalibrating Historical Ties



France co-sponsored the resolution to abandon Mercator as part of a broader initiative to improve prickly relations with former African colonies.

Foreign Minister Jean-Noel Barrot noted that under Mercator, the US, Russia, and China took on a “disproportionate visual prominence” compared to Africa, Latin America, or South-East Asia. Correcting this was a necessary diplomatic signal.

Cartography as Diplomacy

The Math

Solving the 3D-to-2D geometric distortion.

The Mind

Addressing "Cognitive Justice" by removing the systemic inflation of the Global North.

The Power

Shifting visual prominence away from a Eurocentric worldview to reflect the true physical weight of the Global South.

The **2026 UN resolution** proves that **global maps are not merely geographic tools**, but **active political instruments** that **shape international relations**.

An Act of Truth

“Changing maps obviously doesn’t change the world. But correcting a distorted representation is already an act of truth.”

Jean-Noel Barrot, 2026